

subscribe to Ipsy for \$10 a month to satisfy my craving for samples and other goodies.

—Krystal, SunnySweetDays.com

6. BE COSMETIC CONSCIOUS

Possibly the most important way to stretch cosmetic purchases is to stop using sponges. Yep, you heard me right! These tiny tools actually waste your makeup by soaking in most of the liquid before you can even get it on your face. Use a clean finger or foundation brush to help make a little go a long way.

It's also good to use up ALL your product before throwing bottles in the trash. Because I don't like wasting anything, I'll try to squeeze every last drop out of my foundation that I can, and run my brushes through broken eye shadow until there are almost no crumbs left. I kind of make a game out of it to see how much I can use before I have to throw it away and buy new. It's always shocking how many more applications I can get out of each product whenever I do this!

You can even go as far as to cut off the tops of squeeze bottles or remove plastic pumps to continue using the makeup after it stops coming out of the dispenser. A tiny beauty spatula is perfect for this, and I'm always surprised by just how much product is left inside.